Stop 5: The Pantheon (Rotunda of Agrippa & Hadrian)

Curated Coffee, Bakeries, Gelato & Trattoria Guide • Piazza della Rotonda, Rome

1. Micro-Neighborhood Gastronomy & Quick-Reference Matrix

Surrounding **The Pantheon (Rotunda of Agrippa & Hadrian)** lies one of Rome's richest gastronomic micro-districts. However, high monument foot traffic also attracts tourist-trap menus with frozen pasta and inflated service charges. This curated guide filters exclusively for historic roasteries, multi-generation bakeries, authentic Roman quinto quarto and pasta trattorias, and natural artisanal gelaterias within a 2-to-8-minute walk of the archaeological site.

Verified Top 8 Culinary Stops Near The Pantheon (Rotunda of Agrippa & Hadrian)

Venue Name	Category	Price	Signature Order
La Casa del Caffè Tazza d'Oro Via degli Orfani 84	Historic Roastery (Est. 1946)	€	World-famous 'La Regina dei Caffè' steps from the Pantheon portico; iconic Granita di Caffè con Panna layered with double whipped cream.
Sant'Eustachio Il Caffè Piazza di Sant'Eustachio 82	Historic Wood-Fired Roaster	€	One block west of the Pantheon; secret froth-whipped espresso, chocolate-coated coffee beans, and moka pots.
Armando al Pantheon Salita de' Crescenzi 31	Benchmark Roman Trattoria (Est. 1961)	€€€	30 meters from the Pantheon columns; legendary Spaghetti alla Gricia, Faraona (guinea fowl), and Torta Antica Roma.
Giolitti Via Uffici del Vicario 40	Rome's Oldest Gelateria (Est. 1900)	€–€€	Marble-floored Belle Époque parlor serving 70+ gelato flavors, Coppa Olimpica, and homemade maritozzi.
Salotto42 Piazza di Pietra 42	Bookbar & Cocktail Lounge	€€	Directly facing the 11 towering marble columns of the Temple of Hadrian (Hadrianeum); craft aperitivo and specialty coffee.
Retrobottega Via della Stelletta 4	Avant-Garde Italian Gastronomy	€€€	Counter-seating culinary laboratory near the Pantheon focusing on foraged herbs, aged meats, and handmade pastas.

2. Historic Espresso Bars, Roasteries & Morning Cornetti

Before or immediately after exploring The Pantheon (Rotunda of Agrippa & Hadrian), experience genuine Roman bar ritual. In Rome, ordering at the counter (*al banco*) costs a fraction of table service (*al tavolo*) and places you shoulder-to-shoulder with locals grabbing a quick *caffè espresso* or *maritozzo con la panna*.

Featured Coffee & Bakery Stop: Armando al Pantheon (Salita de' Crescenzi 31)

Category: Benchmark Roman Trattoria (Est. 1961) | **Price Tier:** €€€ | **Hours:** 12:30 – 15:00, 19:00 – 23:00
What to Order: 30 meters from the Pantheon columns; legendary Spaghetti alla Gricia, Faraona (guinea fowl), and Torta Antica Roma.

Featured Bakery / Café Stop: La Casa del Caffè Tazza d'Oro (Via degli Orfani 84)

Category: Historic Roastery (Est. 1946) | **Price Tier:** € | **Hours:** 07:00 – 20:00
What to Order: World-famous 'La Regina dei Caffè' steps from the Pantheon portico; iconic Granita di Caffè con Panna layered with double whipped cream.

Roman Coffee Ordering Protocol: *Pay at the cashier (la cassa) first to receive your paper receipt (lo scontrino), then place the receipt on the brass bar counter with a €0.10–€0.20 coin if you want immediate attention during the morning rush. Ask for a glass of sparkling water (acqua frizzante) to cleanse your palate first.*

3. Artisanal Bakeries (Forni), Pizza al Taglio & Street Food

If you want a high-speed, deeply authentic lunch between archaeological stops around The Pantheon (Rotunda of Agrippa & Hadrian), bypass sit-down tourist menus in favor of a historic *forno* (bakery) or street-food counter specializing in 72-hour fermented Roman pizza and fried rice croquettes (*suppli*).

Spotlight Street-Food / Bakery Venue: Giolitti (Via Uffici del Vicario 40)

Category: Rome's Oldest Gelateria (Est. 1900) | **Price Tier:** €–€€ | **Hours:** 07:30 – 00:00
Tasting Notes: Marble-floored Belle Époque parlor serving 70+ gelato flavors, Coppa Olimpica, and homemade maritozzi.

Spotlight Casual Counter: Retrobottega (Via della Stelletta 4)

Category: Avant-Garde Italian Gastronomy | **Price Tier:** €€€ | **Hours:** 12:30 – 15:00, 19:00 – 23:00
Tasting Notes: Counter-seating culinary laboratory near the Pantheon focusing on foraged herbs, aged meats, and handmade pastas.

How Pizza al Taglio Works in Rome

Point to the rectangular tray you want and show the baker with your hands how wide a strip to cut with their shears. The slice is weighed on a digital scale (*al chilo*), folded in half (*a libretto*) wrapped in butcher paper, and eaten warm while walking.

4. Benchmark Roman Trattorias & Historic Osterias

For a full sit-down lunch or dinner near The Pantheon (Rotunda of Agrippa & Hadrian), these vetted family-run trattorias execute the four foundational Roman pasta dishes—*Gricia, Cacio e Pepe, Carbonara, and Amatriciana*—using DOP Pecorino Romano and artisanal Lazio guanciale (never cream or pancetta).

Primary Trattoria Pick: Sant'Eustachio Il Caffè (Piazza di Sant'Eustachio 82)

Style: Historic Wood-Fired Roaster | **Price Tier:** € | **Hours:** 07:30 – 00:00
Must-Order Dishes: One block west of the Pantheon; secret froth-whipped espresso, chocolate-coated coffee beans, and moka pots.

Secondary Trattoria Pick: Salotto42 (Piazza di Pietra 42)

Style: Bookbar & Cocktail Lounge | **Price Tier:** €€ | **Hours:** 10:30 – 02:00
Must-Order Dishes: Directly facing the 11 towering marble columns of the Temple of Hadrian (Hadrianeum); craft aperitivo and specialty coffee.

Reservation Strategy: *Top historic trattorias around the center book out 7–14 days ahead for the 20:00 dinner seating. If you do not have a booking, arrive at 12:15 PM sharp right before the doors unlock for lunch service to secure a walk-in table.*

5. Wine Bars (Enoteche), Craft Beer & Evening Aperitivo

As the sun sets over the travertine ruins of The Pantheon (Rotunda of Agrippa & Hadrian), the surrounding alleys transition to aperitivo hour (18:00–20:30). Skip generic spritz bars on main tourist squares and duck into these dedicated wine bars and contemporary bistros highlighting indigenous Lazio varietals like Cesanese del Piglio, Bellone, and Malvasia Puntinata.

Featured Evening / Aperitivo Venue: Antica Salumeria al Pantheon (Piazza della Rotonda 4)

Concept: Historic Charcuterie & Wine Shop (Est. 1375) | **Price Tier:** €€ | **Hours:** 09:00 – 23:00
Highlights: Directly facing the Pantheon fountain; porchetta d'Ariccia panini, aged pecorino di fossa boards, and Frascati wine.

Curated Lazio & Central Italian Wine Pairing Guide

Wine / Varietal	Region / DOCG	Ideal Roman Dish Pairing
Frascati Superiore DOCG	Castelli Romani (Volcanic soils)	Carciofi alla Giudia, Supplì, and Cacio e Pepe
Cesanese del Piglio DOCG	Ciociaria / Northern Frosinone	Bucatini all'Amatriciana, Rigatoni alla Carbonara, and Roast Lamb
Bellone / Cacchione (Nettuno)	Anzio & Coastal Lazio	Spaghetti alla Gricia, Zucchini Blossoms with Anchovy & Mozzarella

6. Artisanal Gelaterias, Roman Dolci & Quality Verification

Few pleasures beat strolling past The Pantheon (Rotunda of Agrippa & Hadrian) in the evening with a cup or cone of authentic artisanal gelato. Use the profile below and our four-point visual inspection checklist to ensure you only eat slow-churned, all-natural gelato free of artificial emulsifiers and neon food coloring.

Featured Gelato / Dessert Stop: Gelateria Della Palma (Via della Maddalena 19)

Specialty: Artisanal Gelato & Chocolate Hub | **Price Tier:** € | **Hours:** 08:30 – 00:00
Must-Try Flavors: 150 rotating gelato flavors including 12 distinct dark chocolates, Sicilian cannolo gelato, and soy/vegan options.

4-Point Field Test: Real Artisanal Gelato vs. Industrial Tourist Gelato

1. **Check the Pistachio & Banana Color:** Real Bronte pistachio gelato is a muted earthy sage-brown, never radioactive neon green; real banana is greyish-white, never bright yellow.
2. **Inspect the Container Height:** Authentic gelato is dense and kept flat below the rim of steel cylindrical wells (*pozzetti*) to maintain temperature. Fluffy mountains piled high above the tray are whipped with vegetable fat.
3. **Read the Ingredient Board:** By Italian law, gelaterias must display an ingredient book—look for fresh milk, cream, sugar, and seasonal fruit without hydrogenated oils or E-number stabilizers.
4. **Say Yes to Panna:** Authentic Roman gelaterias offer a free dollop of unsweetened freshly whipped cream (*panna montata*) on top of your gelato.

7. Anatomy of the Classic Roman Kitchen (Cucina Romana)

The dishes served in the streets surrounding The Pantheon (Rotunda of Agrippa & Hadrian) descend from two distinct historical traditions: the pastoral shepherd cuisine of the Agro Romano and the historic Judeo-Roman kitchen (*Cucina Ebraico-Romanesca*), the oldest continuously practiced culinary tradition in Italy.

The Sacred Pasta Quartet of Rome

• **Alla Gricia (400 AD+ pastoral roots):** Crispy rendered pork jowl (guanciale), freshly cracked black pepper, starchy pasta cooking water, and sharp aged Pecorino Romano—the ancestor of Amatriciana before New World tomatoes arrived.
• **Cacio e Pepe:** An emulsion of toasted black peppercorns, starchy pasta water, and finely grated Pecorino Romano tossed with tonnarelli.
• **All'Amatriciana:** Guanciale, San Marzano tomato passata, a touch of chili (peperoncino), white wine splash, and Pecorino with bucatini.
• **Alla Carbonara:** Egg yolks, Pecorino Romano, crispy guanciale, and coarse black pepper emulsified off the heat into a silky golden sauce.

Judeo-Roman & Quinto Quarto Specialties

Look for *Carciofi alla Giudia* (whole Romanesco cimarolo artichokes pressed and fried twice in olive oil until every leaf shatters like a potato chip) and *Coda alla Vaccinara* (oxtail braised for five hours with celery, tomatoes, pine nuts, raisins, and a pinch of bitter dark cocoa).

8. Dietary Guide: Vegetarian, Vegan & Gluten-Free (Senza Glutine)

While traditional Roman cooking around The Pantheon (Rotunda of Agrippa & Hadrian) leans heavily on cured pork and sheep's cheese, Rome is exceptionally accommodating for vegetarian, vegan, and celiac (*celiachia*) travelers when you know which naturally compliant local dishes to order.

Naturally Vegetarian & Vegan Roman Classics

• **Carciofi alla Romana:** Whole artichokes braised upside-down in olive oil, garlic, parsley, and wild mint (*mentuccia*)—100% vegan.
• **Pizza Rossa & Pizza con Patate:** Traditional bakery red pizza brushed with tomato, oregano, and olive oil (no cheese).
• **Cicoria Ripassata:** Wild field greens boiled and sautéed briskly in olive oil, garlic, and red chili flakes.
• **Penne all'Arrabbiata:** Spicy garlic-and-tomato pasta; ask for it *senza pecorino* to make it strictly vegan.

Celiac / Gluten-Free Phrasebook (AIC Certified): *Italy tests all school children for celiac disease, making gluten awareness remarkably high. Say: 'Sono celiaco/a. Avete pasta senza glutine cotta in acqua separata?' (I am celiac. Do you have gluten-free pasta cooked in separate water?).*

9. Time-of-Day Gastronomic Pairing Schedule

Whether your visit to **Stop 5: The Pantheon (Rotunda of Agrippa & Hadrian)** falls in the early morning, midday, afternoon heat, or late evening, match your arrival slot with the exact venue schedule below:

Time Window	Recommended Venue	Optimal Culinary Pairing
08:00 – 10:30 AM (Morning)	Armando al Pantheon	Standing espresso or cappuccino at the counter paired with a warm pastry or maritozzo.
11:00 – 12:30 PM (Mid-Day Snack)	La Casa del Caffè Tazza d'Oro / Retrobottega	Warm folded slice of Pizza Rossa or gourmet stuffed Rosetta roll for walking fuel.
12:30 – 14:45 PM (Sit-Down Lunch)	Sant'Eustachio Il Caffè / Salotto42	Fried artichoke starter followed by Tonnarelli Cacio e Pepe or Rigatoni alla Carbonara.
16:00 – 18:00 PM (Afternoon Break)	Gelateria Della Palma / Giolitti	Two-flavor artisanal gelato cup with fresh whipped cream or ricotta-sour cherry tart.
18:30 – 22:30 PM (Aperitivo & Dinner)	Antica Salumeria al Pantheon / Salotto42	Lazio wine flight or craft beer followed by slow-braised Roman second-course meats.

10. Roman Dining Etiquette, Bill Breakdown & Complete Venue Directory

Understanding Italian restaurant billing and etiquette around Rome's historic monuments prevents surprises and ensures smooth, welcoming service at every stop:

• **Pane e Coperto (Bread & Cover Charge):** A standard legal charge of €1.50–€3.00 per person printed on the menu covering linen, breadbasket, and table setting.
• **Servizio vs. Tipping (La Mancia):** Waitstaff in Italy are paid a full living wage. Tipping 15–20% is not customary; leaving €2–€5 in coins on the table for attentive service in a trattoria is warmly appreciated.
• **Asking for the Bill:** Waiters consider bringing the check unasked to be rude. Catch their eye and say *'Il conto, per favore'* when you are ready to leave.

Complete Address & Hours Directory for Stop 5 (The Pantheon (Rotunda of Agrippa & Hadrian))

#	Venue Name	Street Address	Operating Hours
01	**La Casa del Caffè Tazza d'Oro**	Via degli Orfani 84	07:00 – 20:00
02	**Sant'Eustachio Il Caffè**	Piazza di Sant'Eustachio 82	07:30 – 00:00
03	**Armando al Pantheon**	Salita de' Crescenzi 31	12:30 – 15:00, 19:00 – 23:00
04	**Giolitti**	Via Uffici del Vicario 40	07:30 – 00:00
05	**Salotto42**	Piazza di Pietra 42	10:30 – 02:00
06	**Retrobottega**	Via della Stelletta 4	12:30 – 15:00, 19:00 – 23:00
07	**Antica Salumeria al Pantheon**	Piazza della Rotonda 4	09:00 – 23:00
08	**Gelateria Della Palma**	Via della Maddalena 19	08:30 – 00:00